

Passive Reporting Structures

CEFR C1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

To report general opinion without naming who says it, use two structures:

- 1 Impersonal — It is said that he is rich (It + is said/believed + that...).
- 2 Personal — He is said to be rich (subject + is said + to-infinitive).

For an earlier action use 'to have + participle': She is thought to have left. Common verbs: say, believe, think, know, report, expect.

At a glance

Pattern	Structure	Example
Impersonal	It + is/was + said/believed + that...	It is said that the castle is haunted.
Personal	subject + is/was + said/believed + to-infinitive	The castle is said to be haunted.
Earlier time	...+ to have + past participle	He is believed to have left the country.

Learning objectives

- Can form impersonal (It is said that...) and personal (He is said to...) passive reports (CEFR C1).
- Can use 'to have + past participle' for an earlier time reference.
- Can transform between active reports and passive reporting structures.



Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Passive Reporting Structures · CEFR C1

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. It ____ that the company is in trouble.

- A. is said
- C. says

- B. is said to
- D. said

2. The company ____ in trouble. (personal pattern)

- A. is said to be
- C. says to be

- B. is said that
- D. is said being

3. He ____ the country last night. (an earlier action)

- A. is believed to leave
- C. is believed leaving

- B. is believed to have left
- D. believes to leave

4. It ____ that no one was injured in the crash.

- A. was reported
- C. reported

- B. was reported to
- D. is reporting

5. She ____ five languages fluently.

- A. is known to speak
- C. knows to speak

- B. is known that speaks
- D. is known speaking

6. Transform: 'People think he is a genius.' (personal pattern)

- A. He is thought to be a genius.
- C. It is thought he to be a genius.

- B. He is thought that he is a genius.
- D. He thinks to be a genius.

7. They ____ a fortune in the 1990s. (earlier action, personal)

- A. are said to make
- C. are said making

- B. are said to have made
- D. say to have made

8. Correct this: 'He is said that he is very rich.'

- A. He is said to be very rich.
- C. He said to be very rich.

- B. He is said to being very rich.
- D. The sentence is already correct.

9. Transform to impersonal: 'The minister is expected to resign.'

- A. It is expected that the minister will resign.
- C. It expects that the minister resigns.

- B. It is expected the minister to resign.
- D. The minister is expected that resigns.

10. Which sentence correctly reports an EARLIER action?

- A. The painting is believed to be stolen.
- C. The painting is believed stealing.

- B. The painting is believed to have been stolen.
- D. The painting believes to be stolen.

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. is said** — Impersonal pattern: 'It is said that...'.
2. **A. is said to be** — Personal pattern: 'The company is said to be in trouble'.
3. **B. is believed to have left** — Earlier time = to have + participle: 'is believed to have left'.
4. **A. was reported** — Impersonal past: 'It was reported that...'.
5. **A. is known to speak** — Personal pattern: 'She is known to speak five languages'.
6. **A. He is thought to be a genius.** — 'He is thought to be a genius'.
7. **B. are said to have made** — Earlier time: 'are said to have made a fortune'.
8. **A. He is said to be very rich.** — Personal pattern: 'He is said to be very rich'.
9. **A. It is expected that the minister will resign.** — Impersonal: 'It is expected that the minister will resign'.
10. **B. The painting is believed to have been stolen.** — Earlier passive action: 'is believed to have been stolen'.